

Jesus Valera Reales

Senior Software Engineer

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ABOUT ME

- **8+ years** building and shipping products, from data model to UI, with **clean architecture** and **TDD**
- Founded and shipped Narrale, an **AI-powered SaaS** with paid plans, solo and end-to-end
- Experienced in **mentoring** and **knowledge sharing**, including speaking at public conferences
- **Active open-source contributor**, sharing knowledge and driving innovation
- **Collaborative engineer** passionate about **delivering** reliable, high-quality products

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder & Engineer, *Narrale (side business)* 03/2026 – Present | Berlin, Germany

- **Designed, built, and launched** a writing platform for novelists end-to-end: product design, data model, backend, frontend, billing, and deployment
- Architected the backend as a **modular monolith with Hexagonal Architecture and DDD**
- Built a **provider-agnostic AI layer** with credit-based usage, powering story-bible and scene-notes extraction, "Ask your book" answers with cited passages, continuity tracking, and editorial feedback
- Built the **editor on TipTap/ProseMirror** with offline-safe autosave and version history
- Kept quality high working solo with AI coding agents: Spec-Driven Development, TDD, 11,000+ tests
- Ran **user discovery** directly with novelists in online writing communities and turned feedback into the roadmap

Technologies: TypeScript, React, TipTap, PHP, Laravel · PostgreSQL · Paddle · OpenAI API · Docker

Senior Software Developer, *GotPhoto.com* 09/2023 – Present | Berlin, Germany

- **Improved the package customization flow** in the shop photographers use to sell to parents, raising the order rate by 20% while reducing bugs and support overhead
- **Redesigned and rebuilt a shop from scratch** using Symfony, implementing a RESTful API architecture, which significantly improved performance, scalability, and long-term maintainability
- **Extracted components** from the monolith into external services, improving maintainability and drastically reducing deployment time from 30 minutes to 40 seconds
- Drove team adoption of **AI development tools**, sharing practices for experimentation, analysis, and solution design
- **Mentored new team joiners**, guiding them through team ceremonies, knowledge-sharing practices, and technical workflows, enabling faster onboarding and more effective collaboration

Technologies: TypeScript, Deno, PHP, Symfony · MySQL · Docker · GitLab · Jira

Software Developer, *Realtainment GmbH* 09/2021 – 05/2023 | Berlin, Germany

- Refactored the **PHP monolith into a modular architecture** using Hexagonal Architecture, improving maintainability, scalability, and long-term evolvability of the codebase
- Actively **reviewed and influenced architectural decisions**, balancing business constraints with technical quality and sustainability
- Led by example in **code reviews and refactoring initiatives**, raising overall code quality and reducing technical debt
- Promoted best practices by organizing **internal tech talks and coding katas**, fostering clean code principles and a strong **TDD** culture across the team

Technologies: PHP, Symfony, Pimcore · MySQL · Docker · GitLab · Jira

Junior Software Developer, *Kollex GmbH* 08/2020 – 09/2021 | Berlin, Germany
- Built an S3-based file exchange to integrate with external systems
- Developed and enhanced multiple features, including performance and reliability improvements

Technologies: PHP, Symfony, RabbitMQ · MySQL · Docker · GitHub · Jira

Junior Software Developer, *Selectra* 05/2019 – 08/2020 | Madrid, Spain
- Contributed to multiple projects through bug fixes, feature development, and enhancements

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, Redis · MySQL · Docker · Git · Trello · Basecamp

Junior Software Developer, *Smile And Learn* 10/2018 – 05/2019 | Madrid, Spain
- Designed and implemented CSV import and export functionality, along with dynamic PDF generation

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, VueJS · MySQL · BitBucket · Jira

Intern Android Developer, *RAD4M* 03/2018 – 05/2018 | Krakow, Poland
- Designed and developed an application from scratch, with persistent storage and third-party APIs

Technologies: Android, Kotlin · MySQL · Git

EDUCATION

Technician in Web Applications Development 2016 – 2017 | Cartagena, Spain
Centro Integrado de Formación Profesional Carlos 3
JavaScript · PHP · MySQL

Technician in Multiplatform Applications Development 2014 – 2016 | Caravaca, Spain
Instituto Educación Secundaria Ginés Pérez Chirinos
Java · Kotlin · Android · OracleSQL · SQLite · MongoDB

LANGUAGE SKILLS

- Spanish - Native
- English - C1 (Advanced)
- German - A2 (Basic)

CONFERENCES

International PHP Conference
- **Speaker, Berlin** - Solving a Testing & Refactoring Kata: Live Coding in Pair/Mob Programming
- **Speaker, Munich** - From Mess to Maintainable: Real-World PHP Refactoring Techniques
- **Workshop Leader, Munich** - Modernizing Legacy PHP with Pair Programming
- **Speaker, Berlin** - Evolving a Legacy PHP Application: Patterns for Refactoring Success
- **Workshop Leader, Berlin** - Modern PHP in Practice: TDD, Refactoring, and Pair Programming

PROJECTS

Phel Lang , *LISP-inspired functional programming language for PHP ecosystem*
IntelliJ IDEA Plugin: Developed a comprehensive IntelliJ IDEA plugin written in Kotlin for the Phel functional programming language. Implemented syntax highlighting, code navigation, auto-completion, and error detection features.
Successfully published in JetBrains Marketplace, serving the growing Phel developer community.

Language Development: Contributed bug fixes, automated test suites, and design improvements to enhance language stability and reliability.

Website Design: Designed and developed the complete project website from scratch with responsive design, documentation, and a search engine.